

rose from 57 in 2024 to 68 in 2025.

B-schools are realising that traditional classroom learning must be supplemented with practical experiences such as real-world case studies and simulations, a more structured industry collaboration and ongoing mentorship with industry leaders. This will make the transition from campus to corporate life easier.

“B-schools need to adapt their curriculum to keep up with the requirements of corporates. In the age of AI, there has to be a growing focus on developing human-centric leadership qualities like empathy, conflict management, emotional intelligence and resilience. These need to be built in the curriculum,” says Lopamudra Banerjee, CHRO, Carrier Midea India (CMI).

CMI believes B-schools also need to design the curricula to address the complexities of global HR management, international labour laws, sustainability, and ethical decision-making to prepare leaders for a responsible role in a complex business environment. The company hires a large part of entry-level managers from engineering colleges and B-schools.

PRACTICE PLUS RESEARCH

Indian B-schools have come a long way in research—as many as 95% permanent faculty among Top 25 B-schools has a PhD, according to the BT-MDRA study. Investing in cutting-edge research and faculty is the key for a bump in global rankings, say experts.

Also important is academia-industry linkages. Take the case of Anilesh Seth. After a BTech from IIT Madras and an MBA from IIMB, Seth, with about 40 years of corporate experience spanning mostly IT services companies and global capability centres (GCCs), decided to do a PhD. Research had always fascinated him. Over a breakfast conversation, a professor at Indian School of Business asked if he was interested in a PhD. He found himself applying for the Executive Fellow Program in Management. The fee was relatively steep:



TOP 5 B-SCHOOLS

Rank	Institute	Learning Experience (250)	
1	Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad	223.3	
2	Indian Institute of Management Calcutta	219	
3	Indian Institute of Management Lucknow	199.4	
4	S. P. Jain Institute of Management & Research	215.9	
5	Indian Institute of Management Indore	201.7	

TRIPLE CROWN STATUS

SN.	Institute		
1	Indian Institute of Management Calcutta		
2	Indian Institute of Management Indore		
3	S. P. Jain Institute of Management & Research, Mumbai		

TOP 5 EXECUTIVE PROGRAMMES

Rank	Institute	
1	Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad	
2	Indian Institute of Management Calcutta	
3	Indian Institute of Management Lucknow	
4	Indian Institute of Management Indore	
5	S. P. Jain Institute of Management & Research, Mumbai	

NOTE: EXECUTIVE PROGRAMMES FOR GENERAL MANAGEMENT WERE RANKED. NO SPECIALIZED PROGRAMMES ARE OF 9-12 MONTHS DURATION, MOSTLY IN BLENDED OR ONLINE MODE.